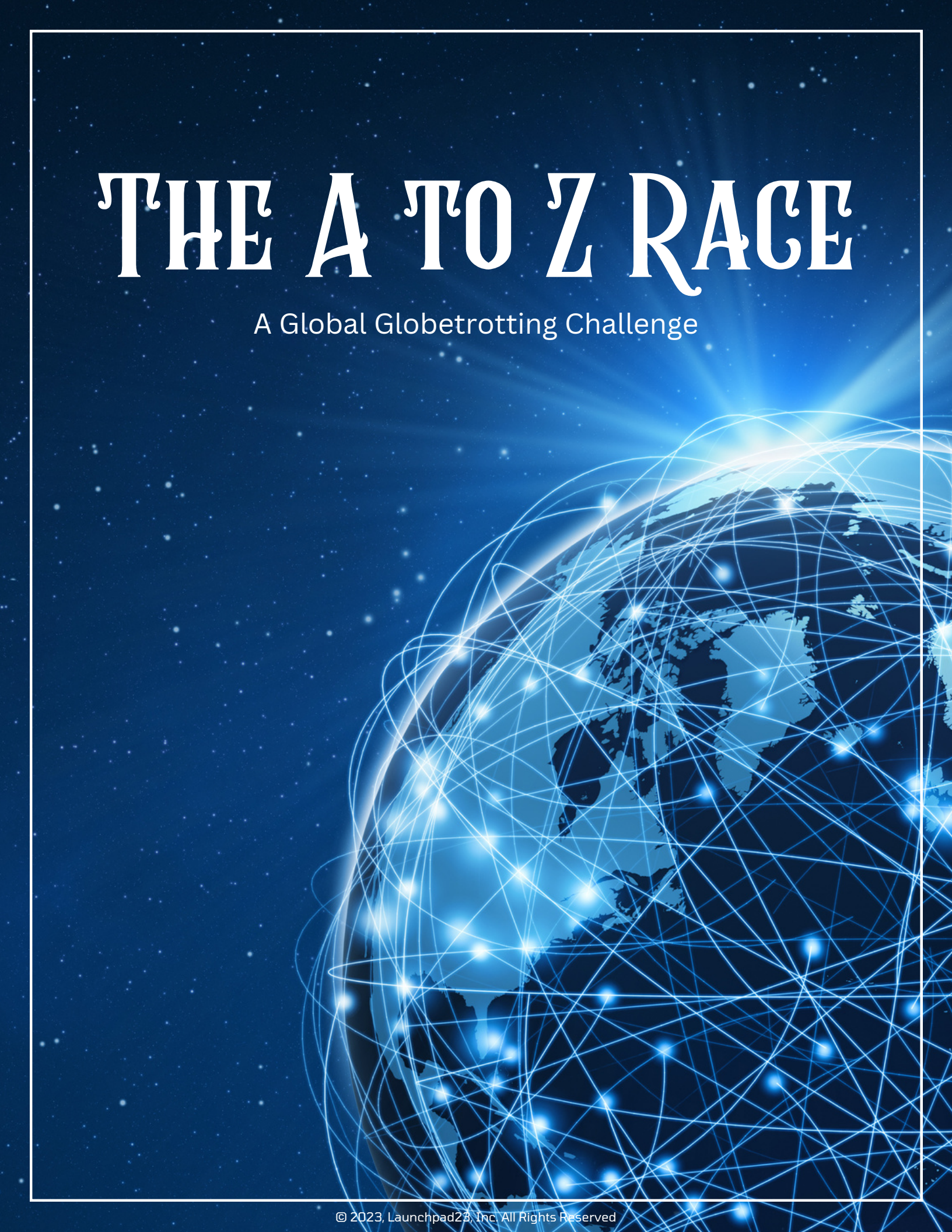
The A to Z Race

A Global Globetrotting Challenge



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READY, SET, GO!

Pack your bags, because you are going on a global globetrotting trip for this challenge.

The goal is to find the fastest route around the world, measured by the number of border transits, and you can do the challenge in two different ways.

- To warm up, complete the challenge using country names.
- For more challenge, try the city version.

The rules vary slightly for each version, so please read them in their entirety before starting each challenge.

This is designed as a team challenge, with two or more teams competing, but can be done by an individual just for the fun of it. If working by yourself, compete against yourself, and see if you can beat your original path with a second attempt.

Remember: speed is not the goal, and your paths are not set in stone. Reconsider, optimize, and keep considering until time runs out!

Resources

- Google Earth
- Google Maps

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COUNTRY CHALLENGE

The Country Challenge

Connect countries in alphabetical order from A to Z based upon the first letter of the country name, minimizing the total number of countries transited. The lowest transit score wins!

The Rules

- **Alphabetical Order.** You must go in alphabetical order from A to Z.
- **The Letter X.** No country name starts with the letter X. Substitute a country with the letter X in its name. You may not re-use a country used for another letter, but you *can* use a previously transited country.
- **Hemispheres.** You must have stops (not just transits) in all four hemispheres.
- **Trip Record.** Record every transit in your trip record. A transit occurs every time you cross a country border. For example, a trip from **A**ustria to **B**elgium would list Germany in between, because it was transited en route from Austria to Belgium.
- **Bodies of water.** Crossing a body of water counts as a transit. For example, a trip from **B**elgium to **C**anada would list the Atlantic Ocean in between, because it was transited en route.
- **For the Creative.** You cannot fly, teleport, or otherwise avoid the rules, *this time*. Make your own rules for subsequent attempts!
- **Optimize.** Your route is not set in stone until time runs out. It is very unlikely your first attempt was fully optimized, so reconsider and revise until you run out of time!

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CITY CHALLENGE

The City Challenge

Connect cities in alphabetical order from A to Z based upon the first letter of the city name, minimizing the total number of countries transited. The lowest transit score wins!

The Rules

- **Alphabetical Order.** You must go in alphabetical order from A to Z.
- **Move On.** You cannot connect successive letters of the alphabet within the same country. For example, you cannot connect Albany, New York to Bangor, Maine, because they are both within the United States of America.
- **Hemispheres.** You must have stops (not just transits) in all four hemispheres.
- **Trip Record.** Record every transit in your trip record. A transit occurs every time you cross a country border. For example, a trip from **A**mstetten in Austria to **B**russels in Belgium would list Germany in between, because it was transited en route from Austria to Belgium.
- **Bodies of water.** Crossing a body of water counts as a transit. For example, a trip from **A**kureyri, Iceland to **B**athurst**,** Canada would list the Atlantic Ocean in between, because it was transited en route.
- **For the Creative.** You cannot fly, teleport, or otherwise avoid the rules, *this time*. Make your own rules for subsequent attempts!
- **Optimize.** Your route is not set in stone until time runs out. It is very unlikely your first attempt was fully optimized, so reconsider and revise until you run out of time!

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TRIP RECORD

Keep track of each transit and stop below. Remember to record every transit, including transits of bodies of water, because they all count. Flip the paper over if you need more space!

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